TWINTHOS · FIELD PLAN · OCTOBER 2026

Who to target.

A 90-day plan for selling screen agents into UK back offices. Honest odds. Real scripts.

One calculation explains everything.

You are not selling software. You are standing in the gap between what a person costs and what a robot costs.

ITEM	PER YEAR	PER MONTH
A payroll administrator costs	**£22,000**	**£1,833**
A hosted unattended bot lists at	**≈ £2,000**	**≈ £167**
The gap you sell into	**£20,000**	**≈ £1,667**

Salary: National Careers Service. Bot: Power Automate Hosted Process, $215/month, list price.

Charge £800 a month.

85%

of their cost, still saved — after you have taken your fee.

THEREFORE

You do not need to be clever, innovative, or differentiated. You need to stand in the gap and charge a slice of it.

Never say these words.

BANNED

~~AI digital employee.~~

~~Agentic transformation.~~

~~Intelligent automation.~~

Say this instead:

> *“That task costs you £1,833 a month. I do it for £800. Same output.”*

The industry’s dirty secret.

222

of the 291 HR and payroll providers listed by Finch — the leading “clean API” — are **human-assisted**. Only 38 are real integrations.

READ THAT AGAIN

The leading clean-API company for payroll **employs humans to be the API**.

This is not a workaround.

> *Screen agents are not a hack around the industry. They are the industry, with the human removed.*

Paycom scores a **C** on the API Report Card: no public API, undocumented partner access, bulk data still moved by CSV.

Four sectors, scored honestly.

SECTOR	DECISION	ODDS
Payroll bureaus	Owner	**Highest**
Care homes	Group	**Medium**
Dental & vet	Sometimes	**Medium-low**
Councils	Framework	**Near zero**

Odds of a paid pilot within 60 days, per approach. Derived on page 13.

Councils require frameworks a one-person company cannot enter. Freight is gated by relationships you do not have. Care has real pain, but the budget sits above the person who feels it.

Target: UK payroll bureaus.

30,000 to 40,000 firms. One person decides. They bill by the hour, so saved hours are money. The work is identical every month. And the software cannot be API’d.

THE SENTENCE THAT OPENS THE DOOR

“You already sell hours to your clients. I sell hours back to you.”

Five reasons, in order of weight.

1. **One person decides.** The owner is the buyer.
2. **They bill by the hour.** Saved hours are cash.
3. **Monthly and identical.** Provable in one cycle.
4. **No API exists.** Sage 50, BrightPay, IRIS.
5. **They already outsource.** Selling work is their model.

Two to fifteen people.

Not the big networks.

Big enough to run a real payroll. Small enough that the owner answers their own email.

THE FILTER

If a receptionist answers, you have the wrong firm. If the founder replies in under an hour, you have the right one.

Cold email does not work.

0.25%

Cold email to paid pilot. One in four hundred sends. Built from a measured **3.43%** reply rate — down from 8.5% in 2019.

STAGE	RATE
Email → reply	**3.4%**
Reply → call	**30%**
Call → pilot	**25%**

Last two are estimates.

Every route, side by side.

ROUTE	PILOT IN 60 DAYS
Warm introduction	**15–25%**
Inbound, after a case study	**8–12%**
Cold, naming their software	**2–4%**
Cold, generic AI pitch	**under 1%**

All estimates, derived from the funnel on page 11.

Your first client will be warm.

> *At one in four hundred, cold email cannot produce your first deal. It can only produce your tenth.*

So the 90 days are not a campaign. They are **ten warm routes and one undeniable case study**.

Four conversations, not four hundred emails.

1. **Your own accountant.** They run payroll or know who does.
2. **Whoever does your books.** Same door, different key.
3. **Bristol networks.** Chambers, FSB, BNI breakfasts.
4. **Bookkeeping bodies.** ICB and IAB branches.

> *“Who’s the busiest payroll bureau you know?”*

Never ask “do you know anyone”. Ask for a specific person. A specific question produces a name.

Don’t buy a list. Read job adverts.

```
Payroll Administrator
Sage 50 · 3 days/week · £24,000
Bristol · accountancy practice
```

That advert publishes, for free: the task, the software, the budget, the shortfall — and the fact that they are spending money on it *right now*.

THIS IS NOT A LEAD. IT IS A BUYING SIGNAL.

Every payroll vacancy in Bristol is a named prospect with a stated budget.

The cold email.

> Subject: the Sage 50 payroll run

```
Hi [Name],

You're advertising for a payroll
administrator on Sage 50 — so the run
is probably taking longer than it should.

I build software that does the repetitive
part of a payroll run automatically, on
your existing system.

Worth 15 minutes?

[Name] · [phone]
```

Name their software. Name the task. One claim. One ask. Delete any sentence that begins “We are a…”

Then stop talking.

> *“I’ll be quick — I work with payroll bureaus on the part of the job that’s pure repetition. What’s the task in your week you’d hand over tomorrow if you could?”*

The answer tells you whether there is a deal. Asking costs nothing.

Fixed fee. No subscription.

£1,500

Two weeks. One named task. If it does not work, they do not pay.

WHY THIS NUMBER

Inside the published UK range for a first build (£1.5k–£3.5k), and small enough that an owner says yes without a meeting.

Answered in one breath.

“Is this legal?”
Your licence, your login, your written authorisation. If the contract forbids it, we stop.

“Will it break?”
Sometimes. A daily test fails loudly, so you hear it from me.

“Is my data safe?”
Scoped login, no copy, full log, deleted on request.

“We have an API.”
Then use it — I’ll tell you honestly if it covers this.

THE PATTERN

Every answer concedes something real, then offers a control.

The two lists.

YOU CAN DELIVER

One named task, automated end to end, in two weeks. Their systems. A daily test. A human checkpoint on money. A written log. Fixed price. Named date.

YOU CANNOT — SAY SO

An SLA. ISO 27001. A track record. Any promise about payroll accuracy liability.

Every competitor overclaims. Naming your own limits is the cheapest trust you will ever buy.

What to do, in order.

1. **Weeks 1–2.** Your accountant, then two names they give you.
2. **Weeks 3–4.** One pilot at £1,500. Take the small fee.
3. **Weeks 5–8.** Measure it. Get one sentence in writing.
4. **Weeks 9–12.** £800/month, then the next task.

What day 90 probably looks like.

OUTCOME	PROBABILITY
One paid pilot completed	**60–70%**
Converted to a retainer	**35–45%**
£2,000+/month recurring	**25–35%**
£5,000+/month recurring	**under 10%**

THE HONEST HEADLINE

£1,500–£3,000 in cash and one reference is the realistic target.

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

You are not selling a robot.

You are selling the hour a week when a qualified human becomes a copying machine — and charging less than that hour costs.

Where every number came from.

- Payroll administrator £22,000 starter — nationalcareers.service.gov.uk/job-profiles/payroll-administrator
- Hosted bot $215/bot/month — thebotdesk.com/a/rpa-platforms-what-they-cost.html (Sept 2026)
- Finch 291 providers, 38 API, 222 human-assisted — kombo.dev/blog/best-unified-api-hris-integrations (Oct 2026)
- Paycom grade C — supergood.ai/api-report-card/paycom (Oct 2026)
- Cold email 3.43% reply — Instantly benchmark via repmath.com/en/cold-email-calculator
- UK first build £1.5k–£3.5k — streamlinedanalytics.co.uk/articles/ai-automation-agency (Oct 2026)
- UK accountancy firms 39,975 — rapportdigital.com/uk-accountancy-firms-decline; 30,032 — poundswise.com
- OSWorld 12.24% → mid-80s — arxiv.org/abs/2404.07972v2; leaderboard.steel.dev

All probabilities are estimates derived from the funnel on page 11. No client results are claimed that have not happened.